

DASHED HOPES

AP PHOTO AMAN SHARMA



<< REWIND

On the back of two series wins at home, serenaded by movie stars and pop singers, the Indian cricket team went to the World Cup as sureshot semi-finalists and dangerous contenders. But defeat to Bangladesh in the opening game and capitulation to Sri Lanka meant the Caribbean campaign had all the energy of a deflating balloon. Rahul Dravid held on to his captaincy but garrulous Greg Chappell quit as coach and India struggled to come to terms with its earliest World Cup exit since 1979.

THE BIG LEAP

Shilpa Shetty went international, without even doing a two-bit role in a Hollywood movie. Richard Gere's kiss gave her a controversy, the lifeblood of a modern celebrity.

FIRST CUT

- A court of law defined mental cruelty in a marriage in the case of Samar Ghosh vs Jaya Ghosh.
- A Hollywood film was dubbed in Bhojpuri, making the heartland

heartthrob Ravi Kissen's voice that of Spiderman.

- A condom bar opened in Chandigarh, urging customers to 'get it on' and harping on safety first, to address the AIDS problem.

<< DID YOU KNOW

For the first time, India and China came together to agree on implementing measures to limit breeding and restrict the population of tigers raised in captivity.